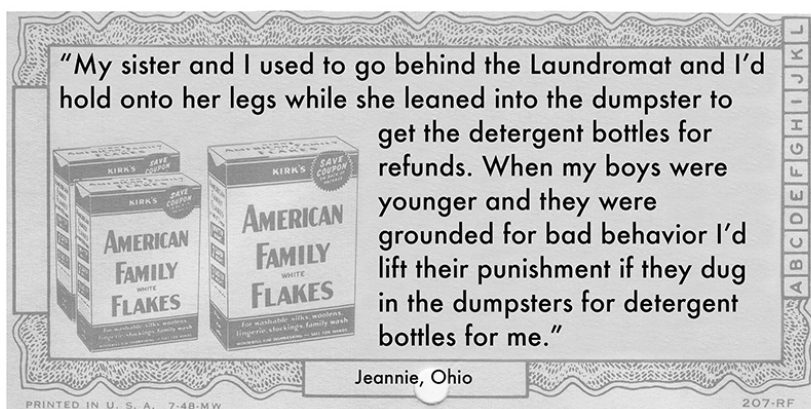


a box top, and yet another, the box bottom, so the savvy refunder kept the entire box. The two file cabinets held the smaller labels and flattened medicine boxes. Whenever an offer came out, I could just go to my files and pull out the proofs of purchase I needed. And in the 80s and 90s, there was no end of offers. One of my 1991 refund bulletins listed eight hundred new offers that month alone.



The idea of filing one's trash is a foreign concept to the average consumer. Only those avidly participating in refunding understood it. In fact, when a New York film crew visited my home in 1992 for a Whittle Communications report on couponing, they followed me around for hours asking questions about both couponing and refunding while filming me in my home and then as I shopped. In the Channel One edited video, narrated by celebrity Joan Lunden, only couponing is discussed. Included is a shot of me filing a Tylenol box in my file cabinet. I am sure more than one viewer wondered what saving medicine boxes had to do with using coupons.

Unfortunately for the companies offering the free premiums and cash incentives, the avid refunders did not behave in the way the companies hoped for. The intention, of course, was to encourage the consumer to